



Dec 26-Jan 1 | Come Follow Me

1. We Are Responsible for Our Own Learning
2. *Intertestamental Period* - ~400 years
 1. History
 2. Language
 3. Sects
 4. Gospel writers

The Rules For Children:

Run
Jump
Dig
Explore
Talk
Build
Tear Down
Pour
Yell

Saw
Hammer
Paint
Ride
Imagine
Sing
Wonder
Measure
Ponder

Play
Be alone
Examine
Experiment
Express
emotion
Be excited
Work
Lead

Follow
Watch
Hear
Smell
Taste
Mix
Create
Daydream

The Rules For Adults:

Observe

Listen

Be ready to "step in" with guidance when a child is on the verge of:

Hurting themselves

Hurting another child

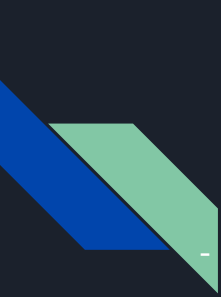
Destroying property





Elder David A. Bednar taught:

- We should not expect the Church as an organization to teach or tell us everything we need to know and do to become devoted disciples and endure valiantly to the end.
- Rather, our personal responsibility is to learn what we should learn,
- to live as we know we should live,
- and to become who the Master would have us become.



Therefore, what?

- Jeffrey R Holland
 - At the end of invigorating discussions among the members of the Quorum of the Twelve, he said President Boyd K Packer, who at the time presided over that quorum, he said he would let apostles have this discussion, then he said he would lean forward at the end of these long exchanges and he would say: Brethren, therefore what?
- How does this translate?
- How does this become a part of me?
- Neal A Maxwell in speaking of gospel learning said there are three things necessary in every gospel learning setting in order for it to really make a difference - to help us, empower us to become who we need to become:
 - Verity => truth
 - Relevancy
 - Urgency
- It's not enough to just teach - or learn about - true things
 - it is important that we teach truth as found in divine source
 - but we also teach them in a way - and we engage with them as learners in a way - where we can look for and discover the relevancy of those truths,
 - to see how they actually apply to us
 - and it's the idea that we need to do so now - I need to find answers today.



The challenge to become

Dallin H Oaks -

This process requires far more than acquiring knowledge.

It is not even enough for us to be *convinced* of the gospel;

we must act and think so that we are *converted* by it.

In contrast to the institutions of the world, which teach us to *know* something, the gospel of Jesus Christ challenges us to *become* something.

...

The Final Judgment is not just an evaluation of a sum total of good and evil acts—what we have done.

It is an acknowledgment of the final effect of our acts and thoughts—what we have become.

It is not enough for anyone just to go through the motions.



Neal A Maxwell - The Four E's of Learning

Explanation - we learn from definitions and descriptions

Exhortations - invite and implore us to do thing

This is where we seem to spend most of our time in the Church

Example - we can see stories and examples played out of people living (or not) the principles of the Gospel and we can learn from those examples and then apply them in our own lives in relevant ways that would fit our circumstances.

All of

Experiences - this is where the deepest growth and development and the most profound, lifelong lessons become rooted in our soul and they become a part of us.

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- 721 Assyrian conquest - when we lost the 10 tribes to the north - speaking **Hebrew**
 - 586 Babylon conquest
 - Babylon they're adapted into this larger culture they begin speaking **Aramaic**
 - 530 Persia took over from Babylon and sends the Jews back home
 - 330 Greece - Macedonians/Alexander the Great
 - Student of Aristotle -> Plato -> Socrates
 - All the learned of the time are speaking **Greek**
 - 1) Fully adopt 2) Adapt, but retain some 3) Resist 4) Run
 - Alexander dies, but left no one in charge
 - Seleucids in the North in Syria
 - Ptolemies in the Southern part in Egypt (Cleopatra)
 - 302 Ptolemies finally prevail
 - 198 Seleucids now take over
 - King goes into their temple in Jerusalem, makes sacrifice, tries to make everyone worship as he did.
 - 165 Maccabean Revolt - Jews take over
 - But the Maccabees didn't come from a priestly family, and a lot of people didn't follow them
 - One of the sons appeals to Rome
 - 63 Rome finally comes and introduces a Latin influences on the Greek culture

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- Sadducees - adopt/adapt
 - Elite - educated - wealthy
 - Controlled the temple
 - More likely to accept, adapt, and adopt the Greek culture to their own lives
 - You watch this group adapt and think :head-scratch: Wait, is that okay? They shouldn't be doing that. Can you still be a good practicing Jew if they're studying the Greek pantheon.
 - They focus only on the Torah - the first five books of Moses
 - You become more like the people you spend most of your time with.
 - Pharisees - to be set apart or separated - resist
 - They start moving the opposite direction of the Sadducees
 - Connected to a group called the Hasmoneans, or the pious ones
 - General commoners who have doubled down on their religious traditions
 - Jesus' audience is primarily represented by this group of Pharisees
 - Most of the Jewish commoners, including Jesus, found themselves most in harmony with and sympathetic to the viewpoints of the Pharisees
 - 613 laws in the Torah - oral tradition continues to expand over many years
 - One of the things Jesus seems to be trying to deal with is:
 - Let's not add cultural things that keep people from truly what God wants.
 - Let's just focus on what God wants and not claim that some cultural way is God's command.
 - Essenes - run
 - Zealots - resists, to the degree of war



Identities, labels

No identifier should displace, replace, or take priority over these three enduring designations:

1. Child of God
2. Child of the covenant
3. Disciple of Jesus Christ

- Russell M Nelson

- Analogy from Hank Smith

- First three - Synoptic - Syn(same - synonym, or symphony) + optic(view)
- Matthew - sitting in the orchestra section, focuses on the sayings, stands up and says: did you hear what he just said, links it back to elements of the Old Testament that Jesus is fulfilling
- Mark - from the balcony, maybe arrived a little late, maybe has a harder time hearing and focuses mostly on what was done
- Luke - he's a Gentile, a convert and also a physician - sitting in the orchestra section - he gives a very balanced view about Jesus being a healer and blessing people who are often on the margins of their society
- John - seems to be right on the stage with Jesus, giving us a backstage pass. Close and personal

Imagine how much poorer we would be in our knowledge of God and Jesus Christ, if any one of these books was missing.

Instead of looking for discrepancies, instead look for: what am I learning from their unique voice?

Christology - the study of the life of Christ

High -> John - those things that emphasize those things that emphasize his godliness.

Jesus doesn't show much weakness, if any at all in the gospel of John. Nobody ever carries his cross for him, he doesn't fall to the ground in Gethsemane, he doesn't need anyone to do anything for him.

Aspirational - I want to be more like Him and I aspire to that stretch goal - I want that as well.

Matthew/Luke

Lowest -> Mark - emphasizes more of his humanity,

More of his mortality, more of the things that you and I can really relate to. All of his stories and movements are among the poor, common people. Mark is going to immerse into those relatable, human parts of Jesus.

Relatable - I want to be around Him.

Come unto me, all ye that labour and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest.

Take my yoke upon you, and learn of me; for I am meek and lowly in heart: and ye shall find rest unto your souls.

For my yoke is easy, and my burden is light.

Matthew 11:28-30